

history, he left only an inspiring example of flaming patriotism.

G. Robert the Bruce.(1274-1329). The grandson of the 1st Robert Bruce, Robert the Bruce spent much of his younger years at the court of Edward I in England. He sympathized with Wallace and aided him secretly in a small way, but had sworn fealty to Edward and received favors from him.

In 1306 Bruce came to Scotland and openly tried for the throne. His strongest opponent was John "the Red" Comyn, who was related to John Balliol. Bruce and Comyn had some sort of agreement to help each other, but as rivals they soon fell out. They were meeting at Greyfriars Church in Dumfries, when they became angry with each other and Bruce fatally stabbed Comyn at the steps to the altar. Bruce was crowned King at Scone, but was declared outlaw and excommunicated by the Pope for his sacrilege at the Church in Dunfries.

With opposition from the family and friends of Comyn, also Edward in England, Bruce became a fugitive and had to fight for his kingdom for many years. His wife and daughter were held by the English, his two brothers were killed by Edward, but still he fought on. He suffered many defeats and often had to hide and be on the run. [One story has Robert the Bruce hiding in a cave after 6 defeats. Lying there, he was watching a spider trying to span a wide gap with a web. 6 times the spider tried and failed, but the 7th time it succeeded. Seeing this Bruce left the cave, rallied his battered troops and went on to his great victory].

In June 1314, Bruce led his warriors against a far larger English army at Bannockburn, near Stirling, and defeated them soundly. Fighting with Bruce at the battle was a large contingent of Highland Clans including the MacQuarries of Ulva. This battle was fatal to the English dream of conquering Scotland by force; it was the greatest disaster ever sustained by an English army, and "the only successful battle on a large scale ever won by the Scots over the English".[19] Bruce died in 1329 at age 55.

H. From Bruce to the Stewarts. Robert the Bruce was succeeded by his son, David II(1329-71) who was only 6 years old. The Balliol family again claimed the throne and David was sent to France for safe-keeping. Edward Balliol was even crowned King in 1332, but by 1341 David's nobles were strong enough to overthrow Balliol and ask David to return. In 1346 David invaded England as an ally of France, was defeated and made prisoner for 11 years. Ransomed for 100,000 marks, he returned to Scotland and died in 1371. Leaving no children he was followed by his nephew Robert II.

Robert(1371-1390) was the 1st monarch of the House of Stewart. The original family name was Steward, which indicated an appointment as Seneschal(Steward) of Scotland. [At 1st the family was charged with being protectors of Scotland and/or the royal family, but gradually they became more powerful and eventually thru marriage to Robert the Bruce's daughter they became the royal family in their own right].

[I. The Stewarts. Robert II was followed by a long line of Stewart kings begining with his son Robert III and carrying on

with James I,II,III,IV & V which brings us to 1542. We skip some details, but point out that in this period America was discovered and the Protestant Reformation began. Both these events would become important to Scotch history. Also at this time Henry VIII was having trouble with the Pope and was embracing his form of Protestantism. The Scottish kings became close to France and remained Roman Catholic a little longer.

[James IV married a daughter of Henry VII of England and their son James V married a French woman and their daughter Mary became Mary Queen of Scots. Mary came to the throne at the age of 1 week and spent most of her youth in France where she became very French and very Roman Catholic. Returning to Scotland, after the reformation, she was unpopular with many factions. She married Lord Darnley who was also a great grandchild of Henry VII, thus strengthening the English line in the Scottish royal family.

[When Mary was forced to abdicate in 1567, her (and Darnley's) son became James VI at 1 year old. Mary was forced to flee and leave her son to be raised in Scotland where he would not be tainted by the French or the Roman Catholic Church. Unfortunately for her, Mary fled not to France, but to England where her cousin Elizabeth I was ruling. Now Elizabeth, one of Henry VIII's many children by his various "wives" and considered illegitimate in Roman Catholic eyes, was not considered the rightful ruler by some. Mary, legally descended from Henry VII, was a threat to Elizabeth and she had Mary imprisoned and later beheaded.

[When Elizabeth died in 1603, the logical successor was King James VI of Scotland who also became James I of England. Thus was set in motion events that would lead to what the English could not achieve by force; the union of Scotland with and its domination by England. Although James was king of both, each country had its own Parliament in Edinburgh and London, but only for the next 100 years. James had promised that he would visit Scotland every 3 years and not neglect his native land. He broke both promises and quickly became "more English than the English".

[The Stewart line continued thru James VI's son Charles I and grandson Charles II. Charles II was deposed by Cromwell in 1651, but restored in 1660. Charles I also had another son James and a daughter Mary who married King William II of Orange (in Holland). Mary and William II of Orange had a son who became William III of Orange (more about him later).

[When Charles II died in 1685, his son James became James VII of Scotland and James II of England. Now James was an ardent Catholic and attempts were made to block his crowning, but they failed. James VII & I had 2 wives; with the 1st he had Mary who married William III of Orange, and Anne (more about her later); with his 2nd wife he had James Francis Edward (more about him later). Rebellions broke out in both England and Scotland (that in Scotland was led by the Earl of Argyll). By 1688 James VII & II wisely left for exile in France with his 2nd wife and son James.

[Conventions (not the Parliaments) in both England and Scotland invited William III of Orange and his wife Mary (daughter of James VII & II) to become joint sovereigns of both countries. Many Scotch people, particularly in the Highlands, were fiercely loyal to the Stewart dynasty which had lasted over 300 years. Although Mary was a Stewart, they felt the male line had moved to a new



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family and began the Jacobite(Latin Jacobus=James) movement to restore a Stewart to the throne, at least of Scotland. Mary died in 1694 and William in 1702.

[Mary's sister Anne was made Queen, but although she had many children, all died young and it was plain she would leave no heirs. The English Parliament, without consulting Scotland, decided to offer the crown(of both countries) to Sophia, a granddaughter of James VI & I, who was married to Ernest the Elector of Hanover in Germany. It appeared war would break out between England and Scotland, but 31 Scottish & 31 English commissioners proposed uniting the 2 Parliaments into 1 that would meet, of course, in London. After much rioting and strife, the Scottish Parliament agreed and the union was completed in 1707. 45 Scotch members joined 512 English in the House of Commons and 16 Scots nobles went to the House of Lords with 190 English. The English domination of Scotland was completed but not accepted by all.

[In 1714 Sophia upset everything by dying, Anne followed her 2 months later and the throne passed to Sophia's son George of Hanover who didn't even speak English. Jacobites in the Highlands revolted and tried to restore James Francis Edward who claimed to be James VIII & III. After a brief invasion of England, the uprising was soon put down by the Duke of Argyll, among others.

[On 3 Aug 1745, Prince Charles Edward(Bonnie Prince Charlie), son of "James VIII & III" landed in the Hebrides and began to raise an army. He landed on the mainland of Scotland at Glenfinnan, was supported by Clans MacDonald and Cameron and some individual MacQuarries. The Jacobite army swept over Scotland and James III was proclaimed King in Edinburgh. An invasion of England got as far as Derby when a retreat was called. The Duke of Cumberland raised an English army and defeated Prince Bonnie Charlie's forces at Culloden in 1746 and the last armed Scottish revolt against the government in London was over. Cumberland was exceedingly harsh in punishing those who participated; life in the highlands was very hard for a long time thereafter.]

I've always heard that the name "MacQuarrie"
is really derived from the word "contrary".

Paraphrase from a speech by
Senator Heath Macquarrie.

All the wives of MacQuarries in the
audience nodded their heads in agreement.

CHAPTER IV

THE LORD OF THE ISLES & THE COUNCIL OF THE ISLES

A. LORD OF THE ISLES. It seems advisable to go back in time and examine 2 institutions with which Clan MacQuarrie was associated and which were often opposed to the regular government.

About the end of the 800's, many upper class Norwegians fled to the Hebrides, Orkney and Shetland Islands to escape a tyrant King of Norway. Unlike earlier free-booters and robbers, these better-class Norsemen established permanent homes on the island and intermarried with the natives. [Since many of the place names on Ulva(Norse for wolf) are of Norse origin(Cragaig = Crow Bay, Ormaig = Snake Bay or Bay of Viking Ships) we can assume they intermarried with the MacQuarries].

These Norsemen made attacks on their homeland so that Harold Fairhair subjugated them and put the islands under a Norwegian government headquartered on Colonsay. About 1095, Godred Grovan, the Norse ruler of the Hebrides, died and was succeeded by his son, Olaf the Red, who was called King of the Isles.

About this time Somerled, "the greatest Gaelic leader of all times" 1st appeared as the ruler of Morvern on the mainland of Scotland. Probably of mixed Celtic and Norse ancestry, he was the son of Gillebride. He gradually weakened the Norse hold on most of Argyre and many of the islands, and also made a political marriage with Ragnhildis, daughter of Olaf the Red. When Olaf died, Somerled established a dynasty that ruled the Western Isles for several centuries. After several generations the head chief took the title "Lord of the Isles". For most of this era Clan MacQuarrie was a loyal supporter of the Lords of the Isles.

In 1164 Somerled rose up against King Malcolm IV(the Maiden) of Scotland and was killed at Paisley near Glasgow. Each of Somerled's 3 sons founded a great Scotch Clan: MacDonald(from Reginald or Ranald), MacDougall(from Dougall) and Macrorie(from Ruari). [The last has sometimes been confused with Clan MacQuarrie, but they were entirely different].

Reginald founded the Benedictine monastery and the Nunnery at Iona and built much of the Abbey Church there about 1203. The Abbey and Nunnery were destroyed during the reformation, but in the 20th century the Abbey was restored. Reginald died in 1207 and was buried at Iona. His burial slab is believed to be the one with a sword, a cross and a small box, in the Abbey museum.

The great grandson of Reginald, Angus Oig MacDonald(Lord of Islay) fought on the side of Bruce at Bannockburn. However, some of the MacDougalls, who were lords of Lorne, fought against Bruce. When Bruce won, he rewarded Angus Oig with forfeited MacDougall lands, Coll, Tiree, Mull and Jura.

Angus Oig's son, John MacDonald of Islay, was the 1st to use the title of "Lord of the Isles" in 1353. He married twice and died(1380) in his great castle in Ardtornish.[Modern visitors who go to Mull by the ferry from Lochaline to Fishnish, can see the ruins of this castle near Lochaline]. By his 1st marriage to the heiress of Moidart, he had a son, Ranald, who founded Clan Ranald, and a daughter, Mary, who married a Maclean of Duart.

His 2nd marriage to a daughter of the Earl of Strathern(after-

wards know as Robert II) produced a son, Donald, who became the 2nd Lord of the Isles. He lead an unsuccessful rebellion and was defeated at the Battle of Harlow. Donald was noteworthy because he was a graduate of Oxford; something very unusual for Scottish Chiefs in those days. Like his father he was a benefactor of the church and was buried on Iona.

Alexander(Alasdair), Donald's son, was 3rd Lord of the Isles and pursued the hereditary warfare against the Scottish King. He died in 1449 and was buried in Chanonry in Ross. The 4th and last Lord of the Isles was John, Alexander's son. Renewing the rebellion he and several other chiefs made a pact with King Edward IV of England to subdue the Scotch Kingdom. John died in 1498 and was buried in Paisley Abbey. All these Lords of the Isles were members of one of the great families of Scotland, MacDonald. [Perhaps to denote the close affiliation of the 2 clans, the commonly accepted MacQuarrie tartan is just a modification of one of the MacDonald tartans, with one red line replaced by two].

From the time of Bruce, the Campbells had been getting the upper hand in Argyll. Many clans went down before this powerful family. The MacDonalds of Sleat, direct descendants of Somerled, were driven from Islay, but still maintained a sort of Island court in Skye. The Macleans of Mull, the Stewarts of Appin, the MacQuarries of Ulva and the MacDonalds of Glencoe were in one way or another brought to heel.

1493 is generally accepted as the end of the Lords of the Isles. In 1504, Donald Dubh, supported by Dunslaff MacQuarrie of Ulva and Maclean of Duart, tried to reestablish the title but failed. During the reign James IV(1513-42), another John of Islay called himself Lord of the Isles, but was forced to give it up.

Thus Somerled's dream to build a dynasty that would be as powerful as the Scotch throne but not as subservient to English kings, came to an end. After 1493 the MacQuarries, who had been allied with the Lords of the Isles, followed Maclean of Duart.

B. THE COUNCIL OF THE ISLES. During the 1200-1500AD period when Highland society was in a turmoil, we find reference to another group called the "Council of the Isles", which was made up of 14 Clan Chiefs. The Chief of the MacQuarries was a member, although he is mentioned only a few times in its records.

The 1st meeting of the council was held on the Isle of Eigg in 1266, and seemed to deal with the money payment for which Eric, King of Norway, surrendered his claim to the Hebrides. This led to a long period of peace between Scotland and Norway, partly due to Eric having married Margaret, the daughter of King Alexander III of Scotland. After its 1st meeting the Council met regularly in Eileen na Comhairlie, in Loch Filnaggen in Islay.

Toward outsiders the Clans were especially independent and always on guard. Although the Council may have helped protect them from more powerful lords or even the monarchy, records indicate it spent much of its time dealing with local and domestic affairs among the Islands.

Chapter V THE BEGINING AND DEVELOPMENT OF THE CLANS

After this rather long, tedious review of Scottish history, it now seems desirable to trace, as clearly as possible, the development of the Clan organization from the beginning. Gregg pertinently observes, "Perhaps there is no phase of the early history of Scotland as complex, and at the same time as fascinating, as that of Clanship. There is a great variety of works on the subject based partly on historical date, but more largely on imagination and theory." [23].

A. A Gradual Process. Clans did not come into existence all at once, but evolved gradually from small beginnings, and differently in different localities. The process took several centuries and was accompanied by jealousies and fightings among the Clans themselves, but many of them became powerful organizations which wielded tremendous influence. "Clan" literally means "family", "children" or "descendants". The Clan began as a natural family group, made up of a patriarch or chief and his descendants.

About 1000 AD certain family names made their 1st appearance. Historians and Chronicles differ about precise dates and specific kinship which existed between individuals. In the earliest times there were no surnames. If a man was called "Donald mac Gregor", this did not mean his surname was MacGregor. "mac" meant only "son of", so his name was "Donald" and he was Gregor's son. But sometime in the 11th century, likely, he became Donald MacGregor, which explains why many Scottish surnames today begin with "Mac".

At first the use of the surname may have been confined to the Chiefs. Later those claiming descent from a great common ancestor would adopt his surname as their own and it became the Clan name. The word "mac" came to mean "descendant of" and applied to female as well as male descendants. Thus all who could claim descent from Guarie, Guaire or Quarrie came to be known as MacGuaries, MacGuaire or MacQuarries.

B. Clan Alpine. The earliest family group to emerge into power was Siol Alpine or the great Alpine Clan ("siol" means "seed, hence descendants"). Siol Alpine was supposedly made up of the descendants of King Alpin (833-836) of the Kingdom of Dalriada, and included the MacGregors, Grants, MacKinnons, MacNabs, MacPhies, Macaulays and MacQuarries. Some trace kinship to Loarn, one of the original Scot brothers from Ireland.

The clan emblem was the pine-tree and its motto was s'rioghail mo dhream (my blood is royal). Siol Alpine was accepted by all other Highland Clans as being most ancient and noblest of all, and for several centuries after Kenneth mac Alpin it furnished the Kings of Scotland and practically ran the country. Later the constituent groups separated from one another, went their different ways and were known as separate clans. All kept the pine-tree as their emblem, but each chose a motto of its own.

Many people will share the feeling of Rev. Daniel MacKinnon who wrote, [??] "It is indeed a pity that the distinctive family mottoes which now hold place should ever have been adopted to the abandonment of that one to which all have a right (my blood is

royal), and which might have bound them together to this day".

C.The Origins of the MacQuarries. The majority of Clan historians agree on two points: 1st, all agree that the MacQuarries belong to Siol Alpine and thus have origins in very ancient Scottish history. 2nd, most hold that the MacQuarries were descended from Guarie, Gor or Gorbred a prince of the Alpine family.

King Alpin, son of King Achaius of Dalriada, began to reign in 843AD and had three sons: Kenneth(mac Alpin), Donald(mac Alpin) and Gregor(Griogar)(mac Alpin). Of the 3, Kenneth and Donald came to the throne. Though Gregor never became king, he was the father of two sons who became ancestors of 2 great Clans, Dongallus(of the MacGregors) and Gorbred(Guaire)(of the MacQuarries). Gregor's grandson, Fingon, was the progenitor of the MacKinnons.

Quoting Martin the historian Douglas[15] gives this descent: "Prince Gregor was the father of Dongallus and Gorbredus, of whom last all Macguaries or Macquaries in Scotland, and the Macquies in Ireland, are descended...Dongallus married Spontana, sister of Duncan, a King of Ireland, and their posterity got the name of MacGregor;...He died at an advanced age about the year 900, leaving by the same royal consort, two sons, 1. Constantine, and 2. Findlands, of whom the MacFindans, MacFingons or MacKinnons, a numerous and warlike people, are descended".

James Logan says: "Doungeal, the elder son(of Gregor), gave the patronymic MacGregor to his posterity, and his brother Guaire was the founder of the Clan since distinguished as MacQuarrie."

Douglas says again, "The surname MacQuarrie is a branch of the Alpine race, their founder being Gorbredus(Guaire), second son of Prince Gregory, son of Alpin Ruoch(the red-haired), King of Scotland who flourished inter annos 770 et 834".[15].

Fingon, the grandson of Gregor, is mentioned in a Gaellic manuscript of 1450 as the ancestor of the Clan Finguin, that is the MacKinnons, whose seat was Findanus Castle in the Isle of Skye(later called MacKinnon Castle), but who also lived in Mull.

Anderson[4], on the other hand, holds that the 3 Clans (MacQuarrie, MacKinnon & MacGregor) were descended from 3 brothers, Guarie, Fingon and Anrias(Andrew) respectively, all 3 being sons of Prince Gregor. So according to both Douglas and Anderson, Guarie was the son of Prince Gregor(son of King Alpin) and thus grandson of King Alpin and nephew of Kings Kenneth and Donald.

Another view held by Gregg[23], is that the descent of the MacGregors was through King Greg, commonly known as Gregory the Great, instead of from Prince Gregor. This doesn't question the descent of Guarie, the MacQuarrie ancestor, from Prince Gregor.

In harmony with the supposition that the MacQuarrie family had its beginnings with the early Alpin kings is the statement made to SamuelJohnson & James Boswell by the old Chief of Ulva(Lachlan XVI) in 1773[9]. He said his ancestors had owned the Isle of Ulva for 900 years. This has been called an exaggeration, but it may well have been somewhere near the truth. Personal descent in the family could have been traced, at least by tradition, clear back to the days of the Alpin monarchy even though the surname MacQuarrie did not exist so early.

D. General Nature of the Clan. The Clan was built on a patriarchal idea, with the Chief followed loyally and willingly as hereditary lord. The highest qualities of a good clansman were to be obedient and reverent to his chief. "The Chief was revered by his family, honored by his tenants... He kept his own seat by the fire, or at table, with hat on his head. His tenants paid rents to him, mostly in kind...i.e.sheep, lambs, poultry. On the other hand, the Chief must be worthy of this homage and respect. The Clan would follow him only where protection and homage led, but cruelty and oppression were never tolerated...The decision of the Chief in an important matter was not always final. If he was weak in understanding or cruel in disposition, he was curbed or managed by the elders... his standing counsellors without whose advise no important matter was decided. As a rule, the Chief sought by every means in his power to retain the love and respect of his people, using all his arts of friendship, generosity and amiability." [23].

MacKenzie [32] writes, "A man whose life and property depended on the willing service of his followers had to behave himself reasonably well as far as they were concerned. He might burn another Chief's castle or rise against the King; but to do these things, or prevent someone else doing them to himself, he had to depend on the Clansmen who were his tenants... Highlanders with a sense of dignity and as much right to the tartan as himself".

A Clan consisted of the Chief, his more immediate kinsmen, and the commonality of the same name; including usually the dependent Septs [23]. A Sept was a branch within the main Clan. It sometimes began when some influential or leading man acquired property and established a family which looked to him as head or Chieftain. This was illustrated when Hector MacQuarrie acquired Ormaig, becoming head of "the MacQuarries of Ormaig". In some instances the Sept became more numerous and powerful than the main Clan. Most Clans also took in a number of so-called "broken men". These were people who for various reasons became detached or estranged from their hereditary Clans and sought protection of another Chief.

Whether Clanship or Feudalism were the same or different has been much discussed. The feudal system proved the most excellent machinery for preserving and giving legal effect to Clan customs ...[it] was the organization and extension of the family--and the homage was due to the Crown as "father of all fathers" [2]. Long after the feudal system displaced it elsewhere, the patriarchal spirit of the Clan system hung on in the Highlands. The Clan-and-family concept were given up only reluctantly and survived until a comparatively late period. People continued allegiance to their hereditary Chiefs irrespective of their place of residence; even after they had removed to the far ends of the earth.

In 1587 an Act was passed which mentioned 3 ranks or degrees of authority in a Clan: The Chief (ceanncine) was hereditary head of the Clan, the Chieftain (ceanntighe) was head of a House or Sept and the Captain (ceanncath) was the actual leader of the Clan in battle if the former two could not act because of age, illness or other reason. Frequently "The" was prefixed to the Clan name to designate the supreme Chief, e.g. The MacQuarrie.

E. The Clans Were Both Independent and Cooperative. The Clans were often subjected to usurpation and oppression by the Scottish Kings. In such situations, usually temporary, the Clans were often forbearing and considerate, yet they always guarded their independence jealously.

At times, although weak and unprepared, a Clan, to its great harm, would not refuse battle when challenged, nor decline to help another Clan when called upon. Goaded it might rush into apparent treason or rebellion against its feudal lord, when the whole thing was just a trap to get its land. As punishment it be reduced to a "broken Clan"; in effect outlawed. The Clan lost the protection of its lord, its lands declared forfeited and control of them was transferred to another minion of the King.

Each Clan had a stated place of rendezvous, where members assembled at the summons of their Chief. The Clan was assembled for a sudden emergency by using a fiery-cross consisting of two pieces of wood placed in a cross, one end of the horizontal piece either burnt or burning, and a piece of linen of white cloth stained with blood suspended from the other end. Two men, each with a cross in his hand, were dispatched by the Chief in different directions and ran shouting the slogan or war-cry of the Clan, naming the place of rendezvous[2].

During the early medieval period there was no such thing as a solidly organized and unified standing army. If a large force was needed in a common emergency, it would be gathered with various Clans furnishing their fighting men and ships. Each contingent remained under the exclusive command of its own Chief or Captain. Clansmen owed allegiance only to their Chief, who in turn held fealty to his lord or King. The firmness of this relationship depended on the overlord's ability to inspire his vassal's loyalty or to hold it by force. Some Clan chiefs were more rich and powerful than their theoretical and legal overlords.

All this often led to a lack of cohesion and unity in fighting battles and waging campaigns. Armies were loosely joined bands of troops brought together, usually for a few weeks, to accomplish some short term military purpose, but likely not for a long drawn out war. The support of William Wallace rose and fell with popular feeling, depending on the immediate cause to be served.

When Clans came together for war the materials they had was what they brought with them. They were not equipped for long sieges or reducing strong fortifications; fire was a main weapon.

Even upon the eve of battle a Chief might withdraw his Clan from the field through pique or other reason and this was not considered dishonorable. Though they might melt away or go home on provocation, they had no taint of cowardice nor lack of persistence once convinced their cause was right. Their spirit of independence made it difficult for them to rise above a provincialism that caused them to think and feel pretty much in terms of their own Clan and its interests.

CHAPTER VI VARIOUS MACQUARRIE RECORDS AND REFERENCES

A. SPARSENESS OF RECORDS. Genealogical records of ordinary Hebridean people are almost non-existent for pre 1760. The births, accessions and deaths of Chiefs may be recorded, but the vital statistics of ordinary Clansmen are sparse. There are few references to MacQuarrie Chiefs by name or to historic events in which the Clan as a whole took part. One bard referred them as "fierce, undaunted, great-feated MacQuarries"[50]. They took part in some inter-Clan struggles allied with other Clans, but for many generations they seem to have kept pretty much to themselves on their lonely Isle of Ulva. The major means of communication was by boat, propelled by sails or oars.

As we look over that rugged terrain today, we get insight into the hardy character of those who dwelt there for so long, poor but independent, having few contacts with others and perhaps caring little about them. This spirit of isolation was typical of most Island peoples somewhat and it still marks them in proportion to the extent of their communication with other people.

B. REFERENCES TO MACQUARRIES. While incomplete and scattered there are some court records and other notices which are available. Many of these are in a book by Black[8].

The 1st Chief of Ulva we find mentioned was Cormac Mhor(the great), whom the last MacQuarrie Chief, Lachlan, acknowledged as an ancestor in his conversation with Boswell & Johnson in 1773. In 1249 Chief Cormac Mhor of Ulva joined King Alexander II's expedition to rescue the Western Isles from the Norse overlords (p21). To this undertaking Cormac contributed three galleys with 16 oars each. In the midst of the campaign Alexander succumbed to fever on the Isle of Kerra(near Oban), whereupon Cormac was attacked by Haakon of Norway, defeated and slain.

Cormac's two sons, Alan and Gregor, were compelled to take refuge in Ireland. There the latter, nicknamed Garbh(the Rough), is said to have founded the powerful tribe of the MacGuires, one of whose Chiefs was later given the title Lord Inniskillen. Thus the present day Irish McGuires as well as the MacQuarries trace their lineage back to Guaire of the early Alpin times.

If Chief Cormac Mhor was strong enough in 1249 to furnish 3 war galleys with 48 men to the King, may this not be presumptive evidence that the MacQuarries had been in possession of Ulva for a long time? Alan, the son who returned from Ireland, became Chief of Ulva and ancestor of Chief Hector who fought for Robert the Bruce at Bannockburn with particular distinction, though he was slain there(1314). David Stewart, in 1822 names 19 Highland Chiefs(and Clans) besides Hector MacQuarrie who fought with Bruce at Bannockburn: Cameron, Campbell, Fraser, Grant, MacDonald, MacFarlane, MacGregor, MacIntosh, McKay, MacKensie, Maclean, MacPherson, Menzies, Munro, Roberston, Ross, Sinclair, Stewart, and Sutherland. Among those also present, but in the opposing army were Cumming(Comyn), MacDougall of Lorn, MacNab.

MacQuarries fought at Harlaw in 1411 in support of Donald, 2nd Lord of the Isles, in his attempt to claim the Earldom of Ross. This battle "undoubtedly saved Scotland from being broken in

two". Success for Donald, allied with England, would likely have revived the power of the Lords of the Isles, but the battle ended his defeat. Maclean of Duart, who commanded 6,000 men with Donald was slain as was the heir to the MacQuarrie Chiefship.

Mr. R.W.Munro has surpassed all other scholars in his research of MacQuarrie history. For many years he delved into obscure records in Scotland and India; his articles published in the Scottish Genealogist[40] are significant and thorough, bringing together meager records of the later Clan Chiefs and ferreting out military records of later MacQuarries. His earlier monograph on the life of Chief Lachlan MacQuarrie(1715-1818) is definitive.

John Macquhory, presumably the Chief(d.1473), was accused of having treasonable correspondence with English King Edward IV, with the possibility of giving his allegiance to the English crown. This was a most radical step, but under the weak JamesIII, political affairs in Scotland were in chaos. I have not found any account of what was the outcome of the treasonable charge. Upon his death in 1473, John was succeeded by his son, Dunsclaff, also called Dunsclavy McVorich or Makworich of Wlway.

Dunsclaff also seems to have been rebellious as he and others were summoned before Parliament more than once to explain their actions; they didn't always appear. In 1504, in the reign of James IV, 11 years after the forfeiture of the Lord of the Isles, Donald Dubh laid claim to that title with support from Dunsclaff of Ulva and Maclean of Duart. Donald's claim fell, but MacQuarrie and Maclean were summoned for supporting him.

In 1509, Dunsclavy McVorich of Wlway was mentioned in "The Acts of the Lords of Council in Civil Cases", in connection with a 2nd uprising of the Islemen under Sir Donald. According to "The Registry of the Privy Seal of Scotland"(1878) Dulleis Makwidy of Ulva "had a precept of remission from the Regent Albany of offenses committed in 1517", i.e. a pardon for (treasonable?) offenses of which he had previously found guilty.

The following story(maybe apocryphal) involves an historical character(d.1551) in an encounter with a MacQuarrie chief. It reflects the turbulent conditions prevailing at the time a man's hold on his property depended on his ability to defend it, by wit if not by force. This account is from Keltie[27].

Maclean of Duart had a natural[illegitimate] son, named Allan-nan-Sop(Allan of the Straw, for his birthplace, a barn) by a beautiful young woman of his own clan. The girl afterward became the wife of Maclean of Torloisk, residing on Mull across from Ulva. Though he loved the mother, Maclean cared little for the boy and was very unkind to him.

One day the lady from her window saw her son approaching, and hastened to put a cake on the fire for his breakfast. Her husband noticed this and snatching a hot cake from the griddle, he thrust it into his stepson's hands and closed them over the burning bread. The lad's hands were severely burned he and stayed away from Torloisk. When he grew up, Allan became a mariner and joined the Danish pirates who infested the Western Isles. He soon got command of a galley, later of a flotilla, and made his name both proud and famous.

Thoughts of his mother brought him back to Mull and one day he anchored his galleys in front of Torloisk's house. His mother was long dead, but his step-father hastened to the shore and welcomed him with apparent kindness. The crafty old man had a feud with MacQuarrie of Ulva, and thought this was a favorable time to get vengeance on the Chief. He suggested that it was time for Allan to settle on land and told him he could easily get possession of the Isle of Ulva, simply by killing the old and useless laird.

Allen agreed and the next morning appeared before MacQuarrie's house. The Chief of Ulva, greatly alarmed, resolved to receive the pirates hospitably in hopes that this might induce them to leave without injuring him or plundering his house. So MacQuarrie caused a splendid feast to be prepared and welcomed Allen to Ulva with every appearance of sincerity. After having feasted all day, the pirate chief, about to retire to his ship, thanked MacQuarrie for his entertainment and remarked it had cost him (Allen) dear.

"How so?" said MacQuarrie, "I bestow the entertainment upon you in free good-will?" "True" said Allen who seems to have been frank and generous, "but it has disarranged my plans and altered the purpose of my visit-- which was to put you to death, seize your lands and cattle and settle myself here in your stead. MacQuarrie replied that surely such a suggestion was not his own, but must have originated with the step-father old Torloisk, who was his personal enemy. He reminded Allen that Maclean was but an indifferent husband to his mother and was a cruel step-father to him, adding, "Consider the matter better, Allen, and you will see that the estate and harbor of Torloisk lie as conveniently for you as those of Ulva; if you must make a settlement by force, it is much better that you do it at the expense of an old churl who has never shown you kindness, than of me, who has always loved and honored you."

Allen-nan-Sop remembered his burnt fingers and straightway sailed back to Torloisk. His step-father came eagerly to meet him, expecting to hear of MacQuarrie's death. Allen accosted him: "You hoary old villain, you instigated me to murder a better man than yourself. Have you forgotten how you once scorched my fingers with a burning cake? The day has come when that breakfast must be paid for!" So saying, with one stroke of his battle-axe he cut down his step-father, took possession of his cattle and property and represented there that branch of Clan Maclean.

This story indicates a society in which the spoils still belonged to the victor. The fact that pirates are mentioned does not undermine the authenticity of the tale. Although old-style Viking raids had ceased, pirates still infested the waters of the Hebrides past the 16th century. In 1605, William Monson was sent on a mission to hunt pirates among the Hebrides and Shetland Islands. John Semple says that Allan-nan-Sop's death-bed regret was not that he had been a pirate, but that he had made only 19 raids instead of an even score[50].

"John McCoirry, natural son of Dunslaii McCorry of Ulway and Langanvasagary, had a precept of letters of legitimation from James V (1532)[42]. In 1545, Jhone Macquore of Ulway was one of the Council of the Isles holding treasonable intercourse with

England. 6 months later McRore of Ulway had a remission from Queen Mary for assisting the English in burning the islands of Bute and Arran and other crimes(1545)[42]. In March, 1558, Hector Makquyre of Ulway received a remission for devastations committed on the Isles of Rhum, Eigg and Canna. Again in 1591 the same Chief received a remission for slaughters committed against the MacDonalds of Kintyre and Islay. In these forays he seems to have been in league with the Macleans of Duart."[40].

In 1603, JamesVI of Scotland became JamesI of England. Though brought up in Presbyterian doctrines and usages in Scotland, he soon went over to Episcopacy which he preferred because it was conducive to royal power, since it gave him more direct control over the Church. So James set out to make Scotland as English and Episcopalian as he could. In 1608, Lord Ochiltree, the King's Lord Lieutenant of the Isles anchored his flagship, "Moon" in Salen Bay in Mull. A number of Highland Chiefs were invited to Aros Castle nearby and then invited to dinner on the flagship. After dinner, Lord Ochiltree rose as if to propose a toast to the King, but instead informed the Chiefs that they were his prisoners. They were then imprisoned in various Scottish strongholds for a year and released only to attend a meeting at Iona for the purpose of signing "the Statutes of Icolmkill".

Whether or not Chief Gillespock(Gillespie) MacQuarrie had been imprisoned, he was present at Iona in 1609 and signed the bond promising cooperation in improving religion and obedience to civil law. The meeting was in charge of John Knox, 1st Protestant bishop of the Isles. Acting as King's Commissioner, he came to Iona to strength royal authority and to bring the Clans into line with Anglican order and the now-English King. Bishop Knox held court near the Abbey and prevailed upon those present to swear to keep the Statutes of Icolmkill.

The Statutes provided for 1 Church subservient to the Crown through royally appointed bishops. Chiefs were prohibited from having large retinues and from practicing lavish hospitality; both had fostered their prestige and popularity in the past. Trade which had been carried on with France should be diverted to the Lowlands, where it would benefit the Scottish Lowlanders and the English. To further Anglicization, as opposed to Highland tradition and the Gaelic language, the eldest son of well off families were to be educated in English-speaking Lowland schools. Possession of firearms for any purpose was forbidden.

Present at Iona were Gillespock MacQuarrie; MacDoanlds of Sleat(Skye) and of Islay; Macleans of Duart, of Coll and of Lochbuie; MacDuffle of Colonsay; Ruari Mor MacLeod of Dunvegan; MacKinnon of Strathaird(Skye); and the Captain of Clan Ranald. The MacLeods and the MacDonalds were made to swear on the Black Stones to cease their enmity and quarreling. In 1627, Cathell M'Quhorrie and Archibald McQkuhorrie are listed as 2 of Mactane's



Village of Ormaig.
Ulva.



Falls in Glen MacQuarrie
(Makquhoyrie or
MhicGaraidh).
Modern Maps show it as
Gleann Mhic Caraidh.

bowman who were being transported from Lochkerran for service in France. The MacQuarries were reputed to be especially skillful with the long-bow and often served as mercenaries.

In 1630, Donald Makquoyrie was legally adjudged by a court to be the lawful heir of his grandfather Hector in the lands of Ulva consisting of Arnallicjh, Noyak, Ormakbeig, Craignak, KilvaEwyn, Golisarimoir, Glakinglradin, Bellegartney, Collecharan, Bearnis, Coll (Culinish), Abos, Soribie, Ferrineynardo and Ardali on the Isle of Ulva; the Isle of Staffa; Drissak, Kowlmwlllyn, Pemnis-auch, Rowiak and Glenmakquhoyrie[40].

Donald allied himself with the MacLeans by marrying Christian MacLean, daughter of Lachlan Oig of Torloisk and granddaughter of Lachlan Mor Maclean of Duart. They had four sons Alan, Hector, Lachlan & John and two daughters Unnah & Catherine, both of whom married Macleans.

John, Lachlan and Hector respectively founded the MacQuarries of Ballighartan, Laggan and Ormaig. Major General Macquarie, Governor of New South Wales was descended from the Ormaig branch. Alan succeeded his father Donald(XII) as Chief of the MacQuarries and is said to have compiled a history of the family about 1648.

In July, 1651, Alan led the clan at the Battle of Inverkeithing near Edinburgh. The MacQuarries were detached to Clan Maclean under Sir Hector MacLean and fought on the side of Charles II, crowned King of the Scots at Scone the previous January. On the other side were the forces of the Englishman Cromwell.

Although not a large battle, Inverkeithing was bloody and proved to be a regular Thermopylae for Macleans and MacQuarries. Chiefs Hector Maclean and Alan MacQuarrie were slain along with 500 men from the two clans(one tradition has only 7 MacQuarrie participants surviving the battle). Both clans had a reputation of standing their ground and fighting rather than giving an inch. Inverkeithing dealt the MacQuarries a blow from which they never recovered. After this battle they ceased to engage in war on any Clan scale, but did continue to furnish groups of officers and men to fights that went on intermittently around them.[See The Cray Connection in Part [4] for another story of this battle].

John & Donald McGorrie of Ulva in 1673 had a "discreet" i.e. a judgement framed against them, no reason given. In 1674 Hector McGowrie of Ulva was listed as a tenant of Gometra & Oskamull. In 1674-5 Hector McQuorie of Oskamull, John McQuarrie of LagganUlva and Lauchlan McGowery of Ulva were all denounced as a rebels; the latter was a tacksman, i.e. a landowner of some importance.

Lachlane Mackouoyrie, son of Alan, succeeded his father as 14th Chief. "He was Chief while war was being waged between his allies the Macleans and the family of Argyll for possession of the Maclean estates, including Ulva. ...Argyll claimed the estates on a pretext of debts owed him, and Macquoyrie's uncles, Hector and John were prominent among those who resisted[40]. In 1683 Lachlan was adjudged heir of his great-great-grandfather and gave bond of 500 merks to ensure his good behavior. In 1690 his estates were sequestered by order of the Privy Council as he was named as one who had been in arms against the government, or at least accessory to crimes of treason and rebellion. It is probable that he was released upon taking an oath of allegiance

to King William later that year[40].

Semple says a group of MacQuarries sided with the Jacobites under the command of John Graham, Viscount Dundee, at the Battle of Killiecrankie in 1689. They were fighting the regime of Wm & Mary of England who also claimed Scotland. Though the Highlanders were victorious, Dundee was slain and his followers scattered since they had been largely drawn by his own personality and prestige. During this turbulent period in the Highlands some MacQuarries made their way to made America. One wonders if they were political refugees or just seeking a more peaceable and properous place to live. It is recorded that a John MacQuarrie was in Lynchburg, Virginia by 1690.[Should this be 1790? See Part 4].

Lachlan(XIV) was succeeded by John, his son by his 1st wife, Marian, daughter of Maclean of Ardgour. By his 2nd wife Catherine, a daughter of Maclean of Coll, he had a son and daughter, Alan and Flora. The son Alan of Culinish, was cited by the Admiralty Court at Inverary in 1722, with several clansmen and others, for stealing spermaceti from a whale that had been washed ashore on someone else's land. Alan married another Maclean, Peggy, daughter of Charles Maclean of the Isle of Tiree.

Flora married Lachlan Maclean of Knockway, son of Maclean of Lochbuie. She had two sons and a daughter, Allan, Murdoch (who became Laird of Lochbuie) and Margaret who married Lachlan MacQuarrie of Ormaig. The last were the parents of Major General Lachlan Macquarie(1761-1824), Governor of New South Wales and of Colonel Charles Macquarie of Ulva(1771-1835).

John became the 15th Chief of Ulva in July 1731. He seems to have been a man of peace who attended to his own business on his own island and let the rest of the world go by. His wife Florence was daughter of Hector Maclean, bailie of the Ross of Mull. After fathering Lachlan(XVI), the last hereditary Chief of the MacQuarries and a daughter Marian, John died in 1735. More complete attention will be given to Lachlan(XVI) and Lachlan, Governor of New South Wales in separate chapters.

C. Worsening Conditions in the Isles and Highlands. From about 1745-1850 some fundamental, far-reaching and cataclysmic changes took place in the life of the Highlanders. Immediately after the rebellion of 1745-6, there came a swift reduction in the population of large areas on the Scottish mainland and in the Isles. This was largely due to cruel and merciless hounding of the Highlanders by the Duke of Cumberland after the Battle of Culloden. The Duke was voted a special income of 40,000 pounds by the British government, but Scots still called him "Butcher Cumberland".

Everything imaginable was done to break up the Clan system, for the Clans and Chiefs stirred the people to resistance and made them cling to their native soil. The entire Clan system was a builder of a high (Scottish) patriotism and filled people with a strong family spirit. In most localities the Chiefs were the only basis for law and order. But in 1747 all heritable jurisdictions were abolished; land sheriffs were appointed to take over the functions and powers of the Chiefs. "About 80 Jacobites were executed, and the Highlanders were forbidden to carry arms, to wear their distinctive dress or to play the

bagpipes. The prohibition of the kilt was maintained until 1782."[19] Many defeated fighters(including a handful of MacQuarries) were transported, presumably to North America and the new regime increased land-rents so many of the larger tackmen also emigrated to the New World.

The English were determined to make it difficult for the Highlanders to make a living in the old ways and in their old communities. The lot of the poor crofters grew rapidly worse since they were unable to pay the higher rents and so were compelled to live in squalid villages or barren corners. Many of the new land owners, largely outsiders, introduced sheep-raising on a large scale. This displaced large numbers of crofters who could not compete with the sheep for the land. The standard of living for the poor had never been high, but now it fell lower and lower, while the proportion of those who could not support themselves rose higher and higher. Much of the population depended chiefly on herring and potatoes.

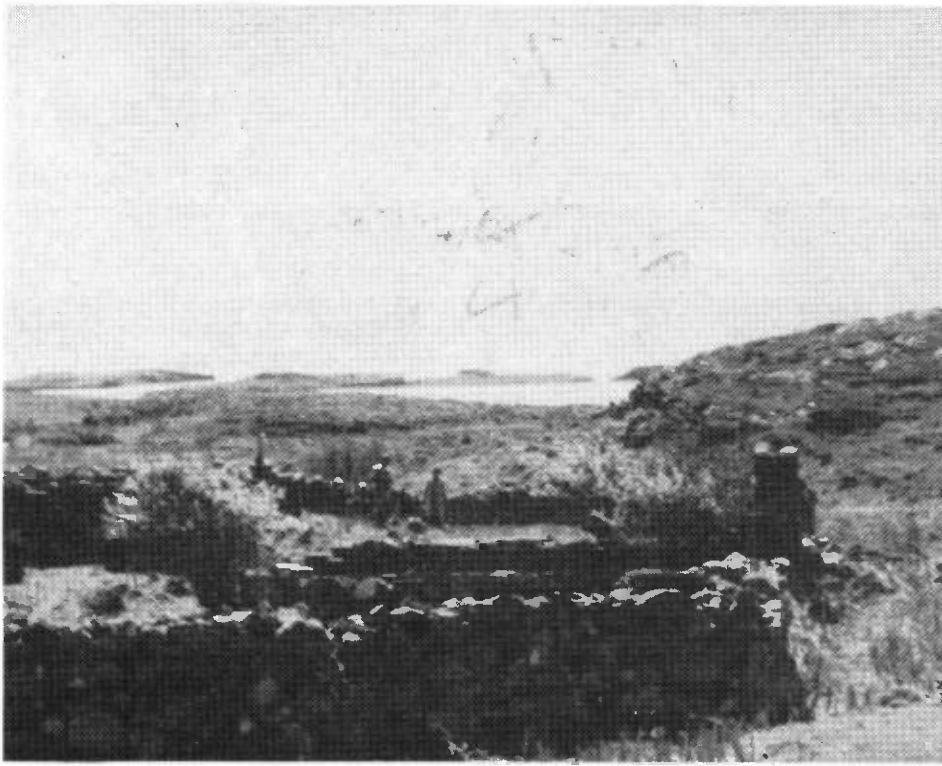
Sample says, "In 1810 Sir Walter Scott found Iona 'extremely desolate and miserable', and the people 'the poorest and most naked he ever beheld'...During the famine-fever of 1846-7, Iona and the Ross of Mull had 2-5 deaths some days; and during the next few years 80 people emigrated--mostly to Australia. Ulva was evacuated, and the Mull Islanders yearly followed to America the legions of Macleans who became scattered all over the world"[50].

During famine some temporary relief was found in employment on the roads and other public works. An emigration fund was created which helped thousands of people to leave and large numbers found their way to New South Wales, Canada and the United States. Before the uprising of 1745, the population of Ulva was probably 800 or more. Crumbling ruins and piles of stones may still be seen in various parts of the island, showing where huts and small villages once stood.

The "Clearances" of 1846 reduced the population of Ulva to probably less than 150. After World War II the Isle was purchased by Edith, Lady Congleton; it is currently owned by her daughter Mrs. Jean Howard. Her son, Jamie Howard, is to be much congratulated for his Herculean effort to make the island economically productive again. The Isle is open for visitors five days a week and MacQuarries are made especially welcome.

D. Records of Individual Military Service. Such islands as Ulva, Mull, Coll and Tiree, while extensive in size, had no sizeable towns and offered any ambitious young man a very limited opportunity for the investment of his ability. If he stayed in the Islands there was little for him to do except engage in sheep-raising, tenant farming or fishing. At best he could make a scant living. To enter the learned professions was a path longer and more costly than most islanders could undertake and there were few positions for them on the islands.

On the other hand the army offered immediate activity, adventure and at least some chance for advancement. The non-physical requirements were not high; boys of 15 or 16 were accepted. In the late 1700s great events were taking place in



Cille Mhic Eoghain(cemetery) in early spring. Ulva.



Cille Mhic Eoghain in early summer. Bracken is higher.
In August it will cover walls and gravestones.

India and North America, unrest in France led to Napoleon who threatened to invade Britain. Throughout the British Isles much pressure was brought upon young men to join the fighting forces.

The list of MacQuarries who went from Mull & Ulva to serve as commissioned officers is very impressive. Many more served just as faithfully in the ranks. The following list of officers is not complete but includes those named by MacCormick[28] & Munro[38]. Some from MacCormick are hard to identify as he gives not dates or service places. Also the names "Lachlan", "Hector" & John were favorites with MacQuarries which often leads to much confusion:

Major-General Lachlan MacQuarrie, 55th regiment, from Gribun;

Captain ----- MacQuarrie, 2nd Dragoons, from Gribun;

Captain Lachlan MacQuarrie, 93rd regiment, from Gribun;

Captain Hector MacQuarrie, HEI Company, from Ulva;

Captain Charles MacQuarrie, 42nd regiment, from Ulva;

Captain Lachlan MacQuarrie, 186th regiment, from Ardmichnish.

Munro's valuable list is based on more extensive research:

Archibald MacQuarrie, 86th regiment(fl 1802). Eldest son of Lachlan MacQuarrie of Laggan Ulva; his commission was obtained by Major Lachlan MacQuarrie.

John MacQuarrie, 20th Bengal, N.I. Eldest son and heir of Chief Lachlan MacQuarrie of Ulva; mother was Alice Maclean of Torloisk.

Lachlan MacQuarrie, 77th regiment. The son of Lachlan MacQuarrie of Ormaig, and Margaret MacLaine of Lochbuie. Served in North America, India and was Governor of New South Wales[Chap VIII].

Lachlan MacQuarrie(XVI) and last hereditary Chief of Ulva, 84th regiment, the Argyll Highlanders[Chap VII].

Charles MacQuarrie, Colonel, 77th regiment. Brother of Governor Lachlan MacQuarrie. After retirement he lived at Pennygown, Mull.

Hector MacQuarrie, 33rd regiment. Commissioned Lieutenant, 73rd regiment of Highlanders in 1797. Died in service in India. Was likely "the promising son" of whom Chief Lachlan MacQuarrie wrote to Murdoch MacLaine in 1802.[Chap VII].

Lachlan MacQuarrie, 86th regiment. Commissioned ensign 1799, aide-de-camp to Hon. John Duncan, Governor of Bombay, promoted to Captain and sent to Goa and died there 3 years later. May also have been a son of Chief Lachlan MacQuarrie of Ulva.

Hector MacQuarrie, 55th regiment. Ensign in 1811, Lieutenant 1814. Married to Margaret Simson who died in childbirth in 1836.

----- MacQuarrie, 86th regiment. In January, 1813 joined regiment at Vellore, India as Ensign.

Lachlan MacQuarrie, 121st Fusiliers. 2nd Lieutenant in 1841. After extensive service he died at age 26.

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An T'Arm Breac Dearg.
The Red Speckled Army.

Clan MacQuarrie War Cry.

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CHAPTER VII

CHIEF LACHLAN MACQUARRIE(XVI) OF ULVA (1715-1818)

A. Etymologically, Lachlan means "the warlike one". That the two most renown men of Clan MacQuarrie bore this name has been a source of much confusion and this is increased with both having been born in the same general area of Ulva and Mull.

They were cousins, but the degree of cousinship is uncertain, since we know little of the General's father except that his name was also Lachlan and he was of the Ormaig sept. It has been said Chief Lachlan was 1st cousin of the General's father. This is likely true; the Chief's father was also Lachlan.

There was an overlap of 57 years between the two men. The Chief, born 1715(the year of the 1st uprising), lived until 1818 thru more than a century of bitter defeat and disintegration for the clan. The Chief was 47 when the General was born in 1761 and since army duties kept him away from Mull most of his life, it is unlikely the two men knew each other intimately.

For years about the only information of this Chief was in James Boswell's "Journal of a Tour to the Hebrides with Samuel Johnson,LLD". On this tour in the fall of 1773, Boswell & Johnson stopped overnight on Ulva and were entertained by the Chief. Near the middle of the 20th century Captain Robert W. Munro, formerly of the Seaforth Highlanders, a journalist with the "Scotsman" newspaper in Edinburgh and an eminent Scottish historian uncovered much additional information about the Chief's life. The results of his studies were published[38] and the following account of the Chief's life draws heavily on Munro's findings.

B. EARLY MANHOOD AND FIRST MARRIAGE Lachlan MacQuarrie succeeded his father, Lachlan, as Chief of Ulva in 1738. He was compelled to pay the Duke of Argyll a compensation "to the last penny...", as the Duke claimed to be the superior of Ulva, which had come down from father to son, from the far-off days of Cormac Mhor."

Lachlan was 23 when he was designated Chief and 30 at the time of the 1745 uprising. Though his ancestors fought beside Scottish kings at Bannockburn, Inverkeithing & Killiecrankie, there is no indication whether he was for or against Bonnie Prince Charlie. Clan MacQuarrie is not named as having fought at Culloden Moor in 1746, but individual MacQuarries did fight(perhaps with Macleans) and half a dozen or so were captured and punished, some by transportation(perhaps to North America). Less than 100 Macleans fought in the battle as both clans still felt the disastrous effects of Inverkeithing nearly 100 years before.

Likely about when he became Chief, Lachlan wed Alice Maclean, daughter of Donald Maclean of Torloisk whose wife was a daughter of Archibald Campbell of Islay. A traditional story about this marriage illustrates the saying "all's fair in love and war".

Apparently Alice was keeping company with a Campbell cousin of hers, who had gone away for a time. MacQuarrie sent Alice a forged letter, purportedly from her absent lover, saying he had gone to marry someone else. Then MacQuarrie stepped in, wooed and married Alice himself! Although marrying "on the rebound",

perhaps she congratulated herself for having caught a Chief.

Learning how she had been deceived, she supposedly composed a ballad telling how, though her husband was a Mull man, she really belonged to a man of Islay. None of this, however, prevented her from bearing MacQuarrie a family of 4 sons and 5 daughters.

Their firstborn was a son, John, who normally would have become Chief of Ulva upon his father's death, but he went to India in the military service and died there in 1777, nearly 50 years before his father's death.[see p39].

The 2nd child, a daughter Marie, brought more fame and glory to her father's house than all his other children. This she did through her four heroic sons, who all achieved military distinction. In recognition of them and her, King George III had presented to her a special medal inscribed, "Mother of Heroes". The sons were:

General Archibald MacLaine, KCB, the defender of Metagorda against overwhelming odds in the Peninsular Campaign; a 2nd son who fought gallantly and was killed at the Battle of Waterloo; a 3rd son who was the only British officer slain at the Battle of Maida; and Colonel Hector MacLaine, who served with distinction in North & South America, the West Indies and the Peninsula.

Their father and her husband was Gillean MacLaine of the Lochbuie MacLaines; the same family from which came the mother of Major General Lachlan Macquarie.

C.2nd Marriage and its Difficulties.[38] Chief Lachlan was married a 2nd time to Ann MacQuarrie, a maid in his own household. One version of a family tradition is as follows:

On Hallowe'en the girls of Ulva were outside playing games, all except the maid Ann who had remained inside to help her mistress(Alice). The Chief himself had left on a journey some time before. Mrs. MacQuarrie urged Ann to go outside and join the other girls in some of the old games, such as tossing her keys back over her left shoulder to see who her husband would be.

Ann went outside and soon came running back in with a great fright, gasping she had seen a vision of the chief himself riding on his brown pony. "But he is not to be back today!" her mistress replied. We don't know the date of this incident.

But toward the end of 1766, the Minutes of the Presbytery of Mull show that MacQuarrie was in difficulty with the Church over his relationship with his maid, Ann MacQuarrie. He had been called to account about this before and had made repeated promises to turn her out of his house, but had not. (Apparently his 1st wife Alice had died by this time.) Then both he and Ann were summoned before the Presbytery, but they did not appear.

In February 1767, the Chief came to the Session of the Kirk of Kilninian & Kilmory, stating his maid, Ann MacQuarrie, had a child some time ago, and this one was their third! The Chief appeared penitent, promised to submit to the discipline of the Church and asked to have their third child baptized. The Session agreed to the baptism "if suitable fines were paid..." Lachlan paid 6 pounds sterling and the Session used it "to cause a wright to make a communion table ... for the Kirk of Kilmore."

Although the Presbytery adjudged that Ann and the Chief were

"incorrigibles", its Moderator, the Reverend Neil MacLeod, "summarily married them before witnesses".

The Parochial Registers, still in existence, record that on February 16, 1767, "Lachlan MacQuarrie, Esq. and his lawful spouse, Ann MacQuarrie, had their lawful daughter Sybla(Sibilla) baptized". The Chief was 57 years old when this took place and this was 6 or 7 years before Boswell and Johnson visited Ulva. Their Journal does not mention that the Chief had a wife in 1773, though Ann may still have been alive.

D.The Visit of James Boswell and Samuel Johnson. This notable event took place in Oct. 1773. Boswell was a very careful diarist and his account of this trip thru the Hebrides is a most valuable record. Since it is not available to the average reader, liberal quotations from the Journal are made here[9]:

Saturday, October 16, 1773: Col determined that we should pass the night at M'Quarrie's, in the Isle of Ulva, which lies between Mull and Inchkenneth, and a servant was sent forward to the ferry to secure the boat for us: but the boat was gone to the Ulva side, and the wind was so high that the people could not hear him call; and the night so dark that they could not see a signal. We should have been in a very bad situation, had there not fortunately been lying in the little sound of Ulva an Irish vessel, the Bonetta of Londonderry, Captain M'Clure, master. He himself was at M'Quarrie's; but his men obligingly came with their long-boat, and ferried us over.

M'Quarrie's house was mean, but we were agreeably surprised with the appearance of the master, whom we found intelligent, polite, much a man of the world. Though his Clan is not numerous, he is a very ancient Chief, and has a burial place at Icolmkill. [Iona] He told us his family had possessed Ulva for nine hundred years; but I was distressed to hear that it was soon to be sold for the payment of debts.

Further on Boswell writes: M'Quarrie told us a strong instance of the second sight. He had gone to Edinburgh, and taken a man-servant along with him. An old woman, who was in the house, said one day, "M'Quarrie will be home to-morrow, and will bring two gentlemen with him;" and she said, she saw his servant return in red and green. He did come the next day. He had two gentlemen with him; and his servant had a new red and green livery, which M'Quarrie had brought for him at Edinburgh, upon a sudden thought, not having the least intention when he left home to put his servant in livery; so that the old woman could not have heard any previous mention of it. This he assured us, was a true story.

A belief that certain individuals possess "the gift of second sight" has long been held among Celtic peoples. "There is a strange, weird and mystic other-world strain running through the Celtic nature" says T.B.Hannan[25]. In our day, when extra-sensory perception is being studied scientifically, perhaps "second sight" should at least be granted a fair hearing and careful examination, and not be laughed out of court as an outgrown superstition. Hannan gives other examples and writes even "St. Columba had this mystic strain in remarkable degree."

Boswell continues: *M'Quarrie insisted that the Mercheta Mulierum mentioned in our old charters, did really mean the privilege which a lord of a manor, or a baron, had to have the first night of all his vassal's wives. Dr. Johnson said, the belief of such a custom having existed was also held in England, where there is a tenure called Borough English, by which the eldest child does not inherit, from a doubt of his being the son of the tenant. M'Quarrie told us, that still, on the marriage of each of his tenants, a sheep is due to him; for which the compensation is fixed at five shillings[about 45cents US]. I suppose, Ulva is the only place where this custom remains.[The editor would hope that the possibility of reestablishing Mercheta Mulierum will not cause a surge in the number of MacQuarries who want to be Chief of Clan MacQuarrie.]*

The next day was Sunday and Boswell & Johnson proceeded to the nearby Isle of Inch Kenneth where they visited with Allan M'Lean, chief of his Clan.

E. Forced Sale Of MacQuarrie's Estates and Later History.

MacQuarrie's statement that his possessions must be sold to pay his debts was no idle word. Less than 4 years later, on July 1777, the chief's lands were sold "by public roup" in Edinburgh, along with the holdings of Hector MacQuarrie of Ormaig, whose father had died only a few months before. The two estates were in badly run-down condition, though capable of much improvement.

Again it was the Duke of Argyll who was demanding that the debts be paid. They had been rolling up for a long time, especially of late when the income from the lands had grown less and less; some may have been inherited from his predecessors. On the other hand, Chief Lachlan was always a lavish entertainer; his fame as a host was widespread and to keep up this lifestyle he borrowed again and again.

The Chief was to be Laird no more. The grim entries to which he put his name, pledging his lands as security for borrowed money, would be listed for future generations in the Sasine Registers of Argyll. The same sort of thing happened to other Chiefs as foreclosures were brought by the scheming, grasping Campbells of Argyll. Allan Maclean had been ousted from his hereditary seat, Duart Castle, in Mull and he now paid rent to Argyll for the privilege of living on the Isle of Inch Kenneth. [Fortunately, Duart Castle was restored to the Macleans early in this century and the current Chief welcomed Clan MacQuarrie there during its 1985 International Gathering on Mull.]

The buyer of Ulva at the auction sale was Captain Dugald Campbell; he got Ulva for the total price of 9,080 pounds. When he heard of the forced sale, Johnson sighed with regret, "Every eye must look with pain on a Campbell turning the MacQuarries at will out of their sedes avitae, their hereditary island."

With Ulva sacrificed to his exacting creditor MacQuarrie was landless, homeless, foot-loose and 62 years of age. What opportunity was there in that world for such a man to make a new life? What could he do? The ever available army offered at least a temporary solution. The American Revolution was going on and many

men from the Isles were enlisting. So the Chief entered the army, even though he had no military experience. He was still active and healthy, and time was to show he was able to fulfill the duties and responsibilities of a soldier in the field as well as the younger men with whom he served.

On Dec 23, 1777, he joined the 74th Regiment of Foot, the Argyll Highlanders, and was commissioned Lieutenant. With 960 officers and men, the Regiment embarked at Greenock for Halifax, Nova Scotia. In May, 1784 the Highlanders were transferred to Penobscot(now Castine), Maine to establish a port there. Lachlan, promoted to Captain, was with this force. The 74th remained at Penobscot until peace was declared, when it returned to England and was disbanded in 1783. In 1784, MacQuarrie was put on half-pay, an amount he would draw regularly for more than 30 years. He had been in the army 6 years.

F.The Last Lonely Years. The war was over and he was home again. But where was home now to be, to a man who had been dispossessed of his ancestral heritage? He was given permission to live on Little Colonsay, a lonely isle in a group lying just off the south shore of Ulva. Once it had belonged to him, but it was his no longer. It was a pleasant enough place in the summer, but the stormy seas which drove in from the Atlantic in the winter made it practically inaccessible. There on that little island the old Chief lived in greatly reduced circumstances. How often he must have been tormented by memories of other days when he was Chief of his Clan and had family and friends around him. We can imagine him sitting there week after week, within sight of his ancient home, yet cut off from it and the world.

In spite of every adversity, however, his pride moved him to try to keep up the appearances and outward show of a prosperous laird. For both health and hospitality he relied strongly on the virtues of Scotch whiskey, and to his friends recommended its use in generous amounts, even though it had been one of the factors of his ruin. Notwithstanding his rigorous living conditions, he was visited at times by several notable people. John Stoddard, a young lawyer, called on MacQuarrie and later wrote:

In returning merrily to Ulva we learnt that an old Highland Chiefain, MacQuarry of MacQuarry, resided in the small island of Colonsa. His fortune, indeed, was decayed; he had parted with Ulva, Staffa, and a very extensive property, and was reduced to his little domain; but still retained the old Highland spirit of hospitality, and would have been hurt at our passing his shore without a visit.... He would not suffer us to depart without going through all the ceremonies of the departing cup.[??]--the wee deoch and doris.

Sir Walter Scott had also met "the late venerable laird of MacQuarrie" and knew of his reputation for hospitality, but he, unfortunately left no description of the old Chief or any account of their meeting. I've never come across any physical description of Chief Lachlan: whether he was short or tall, fat or lean, as to what was his manner of speech or any of the other things we would like to know about him. As far as I know, there exists no portrait of him, nor do we know if he ever sat for one. He

impressed both Johnson and Boswell by his man-of-the-world bearing and by the elegance of his behavior and conversation.

Munro[38] says that even in the remoteness of Little Colonsay and after he was reduced to poverty, MacQuarrie was not free from those who continued to dun him for money. Hector Maclean of Ensay, who acted as agent for MacQuarrie's creditors, threatened to seize his cattle to defray the rent. Murdock MacLaine of Lochbuie, who had obligated himself for its payment, was appealed to for help and sent an indignant letter to Ensay demanding to know the agent's justification for seizing MacQuarrie's cattle.

Several letters which the old Chief sent to his various friends have been described by Munro[38]. In them the Chief reveals his great interest in the careers of his younger cousins, Lachlan(see Chap.8) and Charles. His health seems to have been generally good-- with sailing his boat and taking his cattle to market-- though his eyes sometimes gave him trouble. For a man of 85 he was very hale and active.

Sometime in 1801 MacQuarrie moved from Little Colonsay to a farm in Gribun, "cold Gribun" as he called it. It was a small triangle of land scooped out of the frowning cliffs and could be reached only by a rough mountain road over the hills from Kilfinichan on Loch Scridain. In winter Gribun was "a wild place of lashing rain, pounding breakers and whirling mists, but the island-studded sea which stretched before the cottage door in summer was some compensation." [Gribun was closer to his relatives at Lochbuie who looked out for him.].

Late in 1801 the old man was plunged into heavy sorrow by the death of his son Hector in India[p39]. In a shakily written letter to MacLaine of Lochbuie he poured out his lonely grief:

Language cannot afford words to express my situation in the great loss of a promising son, whom I never had seen since I delivered him to you at Lochow.... I sincerely pray that you and yours, may be rewarded by the great Rewarder of Good and Charitable Deeds, for the Paternal Care you took of him while he was with you. May you, or yours, never feel the anguish, the pain of my very soul. I hope God will enable me to be resigned to his will. So help me God...

"Paternal care" implies that Lochbuie had taken the boy into his household during his tender years. This sort of thing was often done in Scottish families. The two Chiefs were related by marriage and Lochbuie was known as an upright gentleman; an ideal Chief, conscientious about fulfilling Clan and family obligations.

MacQuarrie's grief was made more poignant by rumors that his son had deserted to the enemy. Even worse the story was being spread by his own daughter, Marie MacLaine, mother of the 4 heroic sons. The Chief thought that something should be published in the Edinburgh newspapers about Hector's great bravery and gallant behavior, in order to "contradict this Evel report".

"MacQuarrie is always in need of something": was a frequent comment of his best friends and kinsmen. In many ways he must have seemed a long-lasting and perennial problem. But when his neighbors at Ardménach sent him some peats for the winter, he was profuse in his thanks and wrote, "I shall keep a list of the people what bring the Peats." At another time he wrote, "Pardon me

to put you in mind of my dismal situation here," as he mentioned he could not buy seed-corn for his farm for want of cash. Not all his letters were lugubrious or down in the mouth. He never lost interest in the outside world and wrote while recovering from a sprained leg, "I am longing for the newspapers."

With Napoleon becoming a threat in 1803 Britain was raising an army and on April 23rd, MacQuarrie (nearly 90 year old) wrote to Murdock MacLaine, "In case there are Volunteers to be rised, mind me and late[let] me know if I should write Argyll as Lord Lieut. of the County." In 1804 he wrote, "I expect great news by the next papers, of my acquaintance, Lord Nelson, etc."

Throughout this difficult period of life, MacQuarrie's best friends were the MacLaines of Lochbuie; in suitable weather he furnished oysters for them. When Murdoch MacLaine died in June, 1804, he lost his great benefactor. Shortly before this death, MacQuarrie wrote, "He has fought my battles, for which and all other favors may the Higher Powers thank You and Yours when I am no more."

MacQuarrie was one of the pall-bearers at Lochbuie's funeral, which took place at the ancient family seat of Moy. Present were friends from Mull, Morvern, Lorne and all the tenants of Lochbuie estates and the 18th Chief of Lochbuie was laid, by his request under the great center tombstone in the chapel of Capelle-Fubier near Moy castle. This Murdoch MacLaine was the uncle of Lachlan Macquarie who was to become the Governor of New South Wales.

A month after Lochbuie's funeral, Old Ulva, as he was affectionately called, was present at a happier occasion, the "christening" of Jarvis-field, the estate at Gruline which Colonel Lachlan Macquarie had brought for his manor. Nineteen had a grand meal in the Callachilly Inn. "All did justice to the repast and the good liquor, and old Ulva, in spite of his eighty-nine years, was not behind the rest." [18].

G. LAST DAYS AND DEATH. But time has its ruthless way with us all and MacQuarrie at last had to pay the debt that every man owes nature. One after another the kinsmen and friends of other days slipped away and he was left more and more alone. In his 100th year he was invited to spend his last days under the kindly roof of his cousin Charles MacQuarrie who had retired from the army and was living on his estate at Pennygown, which lies at the end of Glenforsa and has a magnificent view over the Sound of Mull.

Major General Macquarie, then in his 5th year as Governor in New South Wales, wrote to his brother [despite different name spelling] Charles, "I am glad you have offered an asylum to our poor old Chief in his later days, although it is no doubt very inconvenient to you to have him at Pennygown; but I shall willingly pay at least half the expense you may eventually sustain by his residence there during the remainder of his declining years."

Colonel Charles and Major General Lachlan both outranked the Chief militarily, but he was still their chief and they were his Clansmen, even though the Clan system no longer had legal status.

In the words of Munro [38], "All that remains is told in a few letter written from Pennygown in a firm round hand, obviously different from those of an earlier date. They were probably

written at MacQuarrie's dictation by his daughter... 'My state of health for some days past is rather on the decline', he writes in August, 1817, 'but why should I complain? It is but what should naturally be expected.' He concludes by sending the new Lochbuie and his family 'the blessings of an old man', and the letter is signed by another's hand, MACQUARRIE.

On Nov 7 his daughter writes to Lochbuie that her father "is now greatly reduced and very weak... We daily look for his death ... We are much in want of cash". For two months more the old man lingered, but on Jan 14, 1818, he breathed his last. "The venerable, hospitable Chieftain was seldom confined by sickness till the time of his death, and he died at the age of 103", said the Edinburgh Advertiser. It was a pathetic fact that he had lived more than 40 years after being forced off his ancestral lands, an estate his forbearer had held for centuries.

He had long hoped for a burial in the sacred soil of Iona; other MacQuarrie Chiefs were buried there and his express wish was to be at rest among them. His kinsmen and friends started out for Iona with his body, going over land from Glenforsa to the head of Loch na Keal and stayed overnight at the inn of a Hugh MacQuarrie. Setting out the next morning, they got as far as open water when a violent gale set up and the sea got very rough. With Iona still 20 miles away (a formidable trip in bad weather) and since the storm showed no sign of letting up, they gave up the idea of going on and laid the old Chief to rest on Inch Kenneth. They probably remembered young Alexander Coll had been drowned nearby. [The area is also the setting of the poem *Lord Ullin's Daughter*, Part 3]. The choice of Inch Kenneth was not inappropriate; it had long been considered sacred, a stopping place for pilgrims on the way to Iona, and several Kings and Chiefs were buried near the ruins of a Chapel there. The cliffs of Gribun are in sight, as is the Isle of Ulva. Most appropriate of all, the old Chief's father, Lachlan MacQuarrie XVth was buried there.

Munro closes his booklet with these perceptive words [38]: *MacQuarrie lived through a most critical period of Scottish history, the time when the old Chiefs, stripped of their hereditary consequence and yet unadjusted to the new condition, were losing the power their ancestors had wielded. It was a period of change in everything that had to do with the Highlands and the Isles, and MacQuarrie was one of the first to succumb*

If he had been able to satisfy his creditor enough to stave off the foreclosure, he might have been able to stay on his lands for the rest of his days. As it was, he tried to keep up a semblance of his former prestige, but before he died even the semblance was stripped from him. He lived too long.

Years before, Johnson had made a statement which accurately summed up the situation: "The admission of money into the Highlands will soon put an end to the feudal modes of life, by making men landlords who were not Chiefs." Nowhere was this more marked as in Ulva whose story is a sad epitome of Highland history. If Johnson and Boswell had not visited Ulva when they did, we would probably never have heard of the old Chief. Actually he left behind no great achievement by which to be

remembered, in comparison with his illustrious cousin. But he must have been a charming gentlemen, far above his rough environment in polish and elegance of life.

In his story, however, there is a far deeper meaning; it is a symbol and embodiment of the tragedy of the Highlands.

